

MIS MID-EXAM

Important Questions and Answers

Exam-friendly English answers | Important questions are marked with an asterisk

Part A – Basic Theory Questions

1. * What is MIS?

Answer: Management Information System (MIS) is a system that uses people, technology, information, and databases to provide useful information to management. It collects data from different sources, processes the data, and provides information for decision-making.

The main purpose of MIS is to help managers make informed decisions and control business activities.

2. What is an Information System?

Answer: An Information System is an organized combination of **people, hardware, software, communication networks, and data resources**. It collects, transforms, stores, and distributes information in an organization.

For example, a university student management system collects student information, processes it, and provides useful information about students, courses, results, and attendance.

3. * What are the main components/elements of MIS?

Answer: The main elements of MIS are:

1. **Hardware** – Physical devices such as computers and servers.
 2. **Software** – Programs used to process data.
 3. **Control** – Rules and procedures that control the system.
 4. **Database and application programs** – Store and process organizational data.
 5. **People** – Users, employees, managers, and IT staff.
 6. **Telecommunications and networks** – Connect people, computers, and systems.
- All these elements work together to provide useful information to management.

4. * What are the characteristics of MIS?

Answer: The major characteristics of MIS are:

- **Management-oriented** – It mainly supports management decision-making.
- **Management-directed** – Management decides what information is needed.
- **Integrated** – It provides a complete view of different organizational subsystems.
- **Common data flow** – It reduces duplicate data collection and processing.
- **Common database** – Different activities can use shared organizational data.
- **Computerized** – Computers increase the efficiency and effectiveness of MIS.
- **Flexible and user-friendly** – The system should be easy to use and adaptable.

5. What are the important features of good information?

Answer: The important features of good information are:

1. **Timeliness** – Information should be available when needed.
2. **Accuracy** – Information should be correct and reliable.
3. **Consistency** – Information should not conflict with other information.
4. **Completeness** – Important information should not be missing.
5. **Relevance** – Information should be related to the decision or problem.

These features help managers make better decisions.

6. What is the main aim of MIS?

Answer: The main aim of MIS is to provide useful information to management and help managers make informed decisions about the organization and its business activities.

MIS collects and processes data and provides information that helps managers in planning, controlling, and decision-making.

7. * What are the types of MIS?

Answer: According to the course material, the main types are:

1. **Transaction Processing System (TPS)** — Processes a large number of routine transactions. **Example:** A bank processing daily customer transactions.
2. **Operations Information System (OIS)** — Collects, organizes, and summarizes data for managers. **Example:** A factory's daily production report.
3. **Decision Support System (DSS)** — Provides information to help managers make decisions. **Example:** A sales forecasting system.
4. **Expert System** — Imitates human decision-making in a specific field. **Example:** A system that helps diagnose a technical problem.

8. What are the outputs of MIS?

Answer: MIS can produce several types of reports:

- **Scheduled report:** Produced regularly, such as daily, weekly, or monthly reports.
 - **Key-indicator report:** Shows important activities or performance indicators, usually at the beginning of the day.
 - **Demand report:** Provides information when a manager requests it.
 - **Exception report:** Automatically reports unusual situations that require management attention.
- These reports help managers monitor activities and make decisions.

9. * What are the benefits of MIS?

Answer: MIS provides many benefits to an organization:

- Improves personal efficiency.
- Speeds up problem solving.
- Improves communication.
- Supports learning and training.
- Increases organizational control.
- Provides evidence for decision-making.
- Creates competitive advantage.
- Helps automate managerial processes.

Therefore, MIS helps an organization work more efficiently and make better decisions.

Part B — Scenario Questions

10. * Scenario: A university wants to develop an MIS for student management.

Design a suitable MIS.

Answer: A university can design a **Student Management Information System** to manage student-related activities.

The system can have the following components:

- **People:** Students, teachers, administrative staff, and system administrators.
- **Hardware:** Computers, servers, printers, and other devices.
- **Software:** Student management application and database software.
- **Database:** Student information, course information, attendance, fees, and results.
- **Network:** Internet or university network for communication.
- **Control:** Login, password, access control, and data security.

The system will collect student data, process it, and generate useful reports. For example, teachers can check attendance, students can view results, and management can see overall student performance.

Thus, the MIS will improve efficiency, communication, control, and decision-making.

11. Scenario: A hospital wants to develop an MIS. How would you design it?

Answer: A hospital can develop a **Hospital Management Information System**.

The system will include:

- **People:** Doctors, nurses, patients, receptionists, and administrators.
- **Hardware:** Computers, servers, scanners, and other devices.
- **Software:** Hospital management software.
- **Database:** Patient records, doctor information, appointments, medicines, and billing.
- **Network:** A secure hospital network.
- **Control:** User authentication, access control, and data security.

The system can manage patient registration, appointments, medical records, billing, and medicine information.

Managers can receive reports about patients, hospital activities, and resources. Therefore, MIS can improve hospital efficiency and support better management decisions.

Part C – MIS Design

12. * Suppose a company wants to develop an MIS. Design a suitable MIS for the company.

Answer: A company can design an MIS by integrating **people, hardware, software, database, network, and control**.

First, the company will identify the information needs of managers. Then it will collect data from departments such as sales, marketing, finance, production, and human resources.

The system will store the data in a **common database**. Software will process the data and generate useful reports such as sales reports, inventory reports, financial reports, and employee reports.

Managers can use these reports for planning, controlling, and decision-making.

A simple structure is:

Data → Database → Processing → Information/Reports → Manager → Decision

The system should provide accurate, timely, relevant, complete, and consistent information.

Part D – Supply Chain MIS

13. * What is Supply Chain Management (SCM)?

Answer: Supply Chain Management is the design and management of processes across organizational boundaries to match supply and demand in the most cost-effective way.

A supply chain normally involves:

Supplier → Manufacturer → Distributor → Retailer → Customer

SCM helps organizations manage the flow of products, information, and resources from suppliers to customers.

14. * Design an MIS for Supply Chain Management.

Answer: A company can develop a **Supply Chain Management Information System** to manage the movement of products, information, and resources.

The system should include:

1. **Supplier information** – Supplier details, materials, and delivery information.
2. **Inventory management** – Current stock, available products, and reorder levels.
3. **Production information** – Production schedules and required materials.
4. **Distribution information** – Shipment and delivery information.
5. **Customer information** – Orders and customer requirements.
6. **Database** – Stores all supply chain information.
7. **Network** – Connects suppliers, company departments, distributors, and retailers.

The system can automatically provide alerts when inventory is low or when a delivery is delayed.

Therefore, the SCM MIS can help match supply and demand, reduce cost, improve coordination, and make the supply chain more efficient.

Part E – MIS না থাকলে কী সমস্যা?

15. * What problems can occur in an organization if MIS is not available?

Answer: Without MIS, an organization may face several problems:

1. **Slow decision-making** – Managers may not receive information on time.
2. **Inaccurate information** – Manual data handling can create errors.
3. **Data duplication** – The same data may be collected and stored many times.
4. **Poor communication** – Departments may not share information properly.
5. **Weak control** – Managers may have difficulty monitoring business activities.
6. **Slow problem solving** – Finding and analyzing information becomes difficult.
7. **Poor resource management** – The company may not know the actual status of inventory, employees, or finances.

As a result, organizational efficiency and decision-making can be affected.

16. * What are the benefits of having MIS in an organization?

Answer: Having MIS provides several benefits:

- Managers get information quickly.
- Decision-making becomes easier.
- Problem solving becomes faster.
- Communication improves.
- Organizational control increases.
- Managerial processes can be automated.
- The organization can improve efficiency.
- MIS can provide competitive advantage.

Therefore, MIS helps an organization use information effectively and improve its overall performance.

Part F – Bkash-Type Question

17. * Suppose Bkash processes millions of transactions every day. Which MIS component would be most critical: people, hardware, software, database, or telecommunications/network? Explain.

Answer: For Bkash, **telecommunications/network** would be one of the most critical components because millions of transactions need fast and reliable communication between users, servers, banks, and other systems.

However, the other components are also necessary. **Hardware** provides the processing power, **software** processes transactions, **database** stores transaction information, and **people** manage and monitor the system.

If the network is not reliable, users may not be able to send or receive transaction requests properly. Therefore, a strong telecommunications and network system is especially important for handling a very large number of real-time transactions.

In an exam, do not say that the other components are unimportant. Explain why the selected component is **especially critical**.

Part G – More Scenario Questions

18. * Scenario: A supermarket has problems with inventory. Products often become out of stock or are overstocked. How can MIS solve the problem?

Answer: The supermarket can use an **Inventory Management MIS**.

The system will collect information about sales, current stock, purchases, suppliers, and customer demand. The information will be stored in a common database.

When the stock of a product becomes lower than the required level, the system can generate an alert for the manager.

Managers can also receive daily or weekly inventory reports.

This system can help the supermarket maintain the correct stock level, reduce unnecessary inventory, avoid stock-outs, and make better purchasing decisions.

19. * Scenario: A company has many departments, but each department stores data separately. What problems can occur and how can MIS help?

Answer: When departments store data separately, the organization may face **data duplication, inconsistent information, communication problems, and slow decision-making.**

MIS can solve this problem by integrating different departments and using a **common database.**

For example, sales, finance, inventory, and production departments can share relevant information through the MIS. As a result, managers can get a more complete view of the organization and make better decisions. A common data flow also reduces duplication and redundancy.

20. Scenario: A manager wants to know why sales suddenly decreased. Which MIS output would be useful?

Answer: An **Exception Report** can be useful if the sales decrease is an unusual situation requiring management attention.

The manager can also request a **Demand Report** to get specific sales information.

The exception report automatically identifies unusual situations, while the demand report provides information when requested by the manager.

Part H – ERP / Enterprise System Questions

21. * What is ERP?

Answer: ERP stands for **Enterprise Resource Planning**. It is business process management software that allows an organization to use integrated applications to manage business activities and automate back-office functions.

ERP can integrate areas such as:

- Accounting
- Human Resource Management
- Production Planning
- Supply Chain Management

ERP helps an organization integrate information, operations, and resources through a unified database.

22. What is Enterprise Information System (EIS)?

Answer: Enterprise Information System (EIS) is a system that serves an entire enterprise or at least two functional departments.

It can support areas such as:

- Business Intelligence (BI)
- ERP
- Knowledge Management (KM)
- Partner Relationship Management (PRM)
- Business Process Management (BPM)
- Customer Relationship Management (CRM)

EIS helps different parts of an organization work together using integrated information.

23. What is CRM? What are its benefits?

Answer: CRM stands for **Customer Relationship Management**. It is a strategy for managing a company's interactions with current and potential customers.

CRM helps a company build relationships with customers and improve customer satisfaction.

Major benefits include:

- Improved customer support.
- Higher customer satisfaction.
- Higher customer retention.
- Increased revenue and referrals.

- Improved products and services.
- Better performance measurement.
- Support for new business.

Part I – Combination / Big Scenario Question

24. * Scenario: A large retail company is facing problems with inventory, suppliers, sales, and customer service. Design an information system to solve these problems.

Answer: The company can develop an **integrated Enterprise Information System** using ERP, SCM, and CRM.

ERP can integrate internal activities such as accounting, human resources, production, and planning.

SCM can manage suppliers, inventory, production, distribution, and the flow of products from supplier to customer.

CRM can manage customer interactions, customer support, satisfaction, and retention.

All these systems can use a **common database** so that information can be shared between departments.

The system can provide managers with scheduled reports, demand reports, and exception reports for decision-making.

Therefore, the integrated system can improve coordination, reduce costs, improve customer satisfaction, streamline the supply chain, and support better management decisions.

Part J – Theory + Scenario Mix

25. * Explain how MIS helps managers in decision-making with an example.

Answer: MIS helps managers by collecting data, processing it, and providing useful information in the form of reports.

For example, suppose a supermarket manager wants to know which products are selling slowly. The MIS can analyze sales and inventory data and generate a report.

The manager can use this information to reduce the purchase of slow-moving products and focus on products with higher demand.

Therefore, MIS provides the information needed for informed decision-making.

26. * Why is a common database important in MIS?

Answer: A common database is important because different departments can use the same organizational information.

It reduces duplicate data collection, storage, and processing. It also improves consistency and makes information easier to share between departments.

For example, sales and inventory departments can use the same product and sales data. This helps managers get a more complete and accurate view of the organization.